

Privacy Policy

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Dorm Mart is a marketplace for UB students, built and run by UB students. This policy explains what we collect, why we collect it, who can see it, and what you can do about it. The short version: we take what we need to run the marketplace and keep it safe, we don't sell your data to anyone, and you can delete your account whenever you want.

1. What this covers

This policy covers the Dorm Mart website and app. Using Dorm Mart means you accept this policy and our Terms of Service.

Dorm Mart is student-run and is not an official University at Buffalo service. We use your UB email to confirm you're a student. It does not give us access to anything in university systems.

2. What we collect

Account and profile

- Your first and last name.
- Your UB email address (@buffalo.edu).
- Your password, stored as a one-way hash. We can't read it or recover it, which is why a reset replaces it instead of retrieving it.
- Your graduation month and year.
- A profile photo, if you upload one.
- A phone number, only if you add one and switch on contact sharing in Settings.

What you create on the platform

- Listings: photos, titles, descriptions, prices, categories, and pickup details.
- Messages you send other users.
- Reviews and ratings you write, and the ones you receive.
- Wishlist items, and the alerts they trigger.
- Scheduled purchases and completed transaction records.

Sign-in and device records

- Device type, browser, and operating system.
- IP address, and the approximate city it maps to.
- Sign-in times and active sessions, so you can see your own logged-in devices in Settings and sign out the ones you don't recognize.

Usage and diagnostics

- Which features you use and when.
- Server request logs and error reports, used to find bugs and keep the site up.

Support and reports

- Messages you send the team.
- Reports you file about another user, and reports filed about you.

We don't collect your grades, class schedule, or anything else from university systems. We don't track your location in the background, read your contacts, or follow you around other websites.

We never see or store full card numbers. If optional card payments are switched on, Stripe handles the payment form directly, and may ask sellers for identity, tax, or bank details in order to pay them out. That information goes to Stripe under Stripe's own privacy policy, not to us.

3. Why we collect it

- To create your account and confirm you're a current UB student.
- To run the marketplace: listings, search, chat, wishlist alerts, scheduled purchases, and reviews.
- To notify you about your own activity, like a new message, an accepted schedule, or a wishlisted item that came back in stock.
- To keep the place safe: rate limiting, fraud detection, investigating reports, and enforcing bans.
- To fix what's broken, using error logs and performance data.
- To respond when the law requires it, and to enforce our Terms.

Email you'll get from us

- Account and transaction email you can't turn off: verification, password resets, security alerts, and notices about your own purchases.
- Promotional email only if you ask for it. You choose the frequency in Settings, and off is the default.

4. The legal basis, if you're asking

If you're covered by the GDPR or a similar law, here's what we rely on:

- Performing our contract with you, which is running the Service you signed up for.
- Legitimate interests: keeping the platform secure, preventing fraud, and improving how it works.
- Your consent, for promotional email and any non-essential cookies.
- Legal obligations, when a law or a lawful request requires something of us.

5. What other students can see

- Your display name and profile photo.
- Your graduation year.
- Listings you post, including photos and descriptions.
- Reviews you've written, and the average rating you've earned.

Your phone number stays hidden unless you add one and turn on contact sharing yourself. Your messages go to the person you sent them to and nobody else.

Moderators can read a reported conversation, but only the reported thread and only while they're looking into a report. They can't browse your messages for fun.

6. Who else we share with

We don't sell your personal information, and we don't share it for advertising. Beyond what other students see, your data leaves Dorm Mart in four situations:

- Service providers we need to operate: hosting, the database, email delivery, and error monitoring. They're contractually limited to the job we hired them for.
- Stripe, if optional card payments are switched on and you use them, so sellers can be paid and disputes can be handled.
- Safety and law enforcement, when there's a valid court order or subpoena, or when someone is in immediate danger. We'll tell you when this happens unless we're legally barred from telling you.
- A future owner, if Dorm Mart is ever transferred to one. You'd get notice before that happened.

What never leaves: your private messages beyond their recipient, your browsing patterns, and your transaction history.

7. Cookies and local storage

- Session and security cookies keep you signed in and block cross-site request forgery. These are required, and the site won't work without them.
- Local storage holds small preferences, like whether you're in dark mode.
- We don't run third-party advertising or tracking cookies. There are none to opt out of.

Some browsers send a "Do Not Track" signal. There's no agreed standard for honoring it, so we don't act on it specifically, but we also don't do the cross-site tracking it was invented to stop.

8. How long we keep things

- Account and profile data: as long as your account is open.
- Listings, messages, and reviews: while your account is open, plus a limited window afterward so we can finish investigations and meet audit needs.
- Sign-in and security logs: typically 12 to 24 months.
- Inactive accounts: deleted after two years with no sign-in.
- Transaction and payment records: kept as long as accounting, tax, and dispute rules require. Where Stripe was involved, Stripe keeps its own copy under its own schedule.
- Backups: they age out on a fixed rotation, so deleted data can sit in a backup for a short time before it's gone for good.

9. How we protect it

On our side: traffic is encrypted in transit, passwords are hashed, database access is limited to the people who need it, and input is validated to block SQL injection and cross-site scripting. Sensitive actions require a CSRF token, and requests are rate limited.

No system is perfectly secure, and we're not going to pretend otherwise. If we find a breach, we'll investigate it, shut it down, and notify you and the authorities as the New York SHIELD Act requires.

What you can do

- Use a password you don't use anywhere else.
- Turn on two-factor authentication in Settings.
- Check your signed-in devices in Settings and end any session you don't recognize.
- Sign out on shared and lab computers.
- Tell us right away if something looks wrong with your account.

10. What you can control

- Edit your profile, graduation year, and preferences in Settings.
- Turn promotional email on or off, and change how often it arrives.
- Show or hide your phone number.
- Review your sign-in history and end sessions you don't recognize.
- Change your password, and turn two-factor authentication on or off.
- Delete your account from Settings. You'll confirm with your password and by typing DELETE MY ACCOUNT. Your listings come down, your uploaded photos are removed, and anyone who wishlisted your items is told the listing is gone.

Deletion removes your personal data. We keep the minimum required for legal, tax, and fraud-prevention reasons, which is typically a stripped-down transaction record with no profile attached to it.

If your local law gives you the right to a copy of your data, to correct it, to restrict how it's used, or to object to it, contact us and we'll handle it. We may ask you to confirm the account is really yours first.

11. Where your data lives

Dorm Mart is hosted in the United States, and that's where your data is stored and processed.

International students

- Your data is processed under U.S. law, which may protect it differently than the law where you're from.
- You get exactly the same privacy rights as every other user. Nothing about your citizenship or visa status changes what we collect or what you can control.
- If you have a specific concern about your data crossing borders, contact us and ask.

12. FERPA and your student records

We're a student-to-student marketplace, not an arm of the university and not a service provider handling education records on UB's behalf. FERPA doesn't apply to what you give us.

Use some discretion anyway. Don't post grades, transcripts, or coursework here, because it isn't protected the way it would be in a university system.

13. Age

Dorm Mart is for adults. You need to be 18 or older to hold an account. If we learn an account belongs to someone under 18, we'll close it.

14. Third parties we don't control

If optional card payments are switched on, Stripe's payment form collects card details directly and Stripe may set its own cookies for security and fraud prevention. Read Stripe's privacy policy before you connect an account or pay through it.

Anything that happens off Dorm Mart is outside this policy and outside our control: a payment app, a text thread, a meetup you arranged somewhere else. Check the privacy terms of whatever you're using before you share anything there.

15. Changes to this policy

This policy will change as the platform does. The date at the top tells you when it last moved. If a change is significant, we'll post a notice in the app rather than hoping you noticed. Continuing to use Dorm Mart after a change means you accept it.

16. Contact us

Questions, requests, or concerns about your data go to the Dorm Mart team. Our contact details are under Settings > About Us.

For anything involving safety or another user's behavior, use the report button in the app. It reaches a moderator faster than email does.